

2019

Higher School Certificate
Trial Examination

English Advanced

Paper 1 — Texts and Human Experiences

Stimulus Booklet for Section I *and* List of prescribed texts for Section II

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This paper MUST NOT be removed from the examination room

Section I**Text 1 — Memoir**

—by Hillary Rodham Clinton, Former First Lady of the United States of America

Choosing a single Aha! moment is nearly impossible. I've been blessed with a life filled with wonderful experiences — and epiphanies*. But there is one in particular that stands out in my mind.

Early in 1999, speculation was growing that I would enter the U.S. Senate race in New York. In fact, reading the newspaper or watching television, it seemed that the only person in the world not convinced I would run was me.

But there were so many things to consider. And so many obstacles. No First Lady had ever before sought public office. And I had never run for office myself. Sure, I'd campaigned all over the country, for my husband and for other candidates. But I was used to getting onstage and talking about the virtues of someone else. Would I be able to earn the trust of New Yorkers? Would I make a good candidate? Did I have what it takes?

It was an incredibly difficult decision, and I needed a push. Fortunately, I got one. In March of that year, I went to New York City to promote a documentary about women in sports. (Lucky for me, athletic ability was not required for entry to the event.) We gathered at a local school, joined by dozens of young women athletes, all of us assembled on a stage beneath a giant banner that read dare to compete, the title of the film. A young woman named Sofia Totti, the captain of the girls' basketball team at the school, introduced me.

And then something unexpected happened. As I approached the microphone to say a few words about the importance of giving girls every opportunity to grow and reach their potential, Sofia grabbed my hand and whispered in my ear: "Dare to compete, Mrs. Clinton," she said. "Dare to compete."

I was stunned — genuinely caught off guard. Late into that night, I was still thinking about what she'd said. I started to ask myself questions that had been lurking in the back of my mind for a long time. How can I give in to my fears and fail to do something I have urged countless other women to do? Why am I so hesitant about taking on this challenge? Why aren't I thinking more seriously about it?

All of us struggle to be the best we can be. All of us wonder at times whether what lies ahead is too difficult or too challenging. In truth, sometimes our most fearsome competitor is our self, as we face our own doubts and fears on the way to reaching our potential.

Daring to compete isn't always easy. But Sofia, in her optimism and enthusiasm, in her spirit and drive, reminded me why it's so important. Soon after her challenge, I decided to risk being the best I could be and entered the race. Now, as a senator representing New York and fighting in Congress on the issues I care about, I can look back and say that the Aha! moment Sofia inspired was one of the most important of my life. Maybe next I'll dare to work on my jump shot.

* An epiphany is:

- a moment when you suddenly feel that you understand, or suddenly become conscious of, something that is very important to you
- a powerful religious experience

Text 2 — Fiction extract

—from *An Equal Music*, by Vikram Seth

The branches are bare, the sky tonight a milky violet. It is not quiet here, but it is peaceful. The wind ruffles the black water towards me.

There is no one about. The birds are still. The traffic slashes through Hyde Park. It comes to my ears as white noise.

A few days ago I was told I was happy by the young woman behind the counter at Etienne's. I ordered seven croissants. As she gave me my change she said: "You are a happy man."

I stared at her with such incredulity that she looked down.

"You're always humming," she said in a much quieter voice, feeling perhaps that she had to explain.

"It's my work," I said, ashamed of my bitterness. Another customer entered the shop, and I left.

As I put my week's croissants - all except one - in the freezer, I noticed I was humming the same half-tuneless tune of one of Schubert's last songs:

*I see a man who stares upwards
And wrings his hands from the force of his pain.
I shudder when I see his face.
The moon reveals myself to me.*

I put the water on for coffee, and look out of the window. From the eighth floor I can see as far as St Paul's, Croydon, Highgate. I can look across the brown-branched park to spires and towers and chimneys beyond. London unsettles me - even from such a height there is no clear countryside to view.

But it is not Vienna. It is not Venice. It is not, for that matter, my hometown in the North, in clear reach of the moors.

It wasn't my work, though, that made me hum that song. I have not played Schubert for more than a month. My violin misses him more than I do. I tune it, and we enter my soundproof cell. No light, no sound comes in from the world. Electrons along copper, horsehair across acrylic create my impressions of sense.

Text 2 continues on page 4

Text 2 continued

I will play nothing of what we have played in our quartet, nothing that reminds me of my recent music-making with any human being. I will play his songs.

The Tononi* seems to purr at the suggestion. Something happy, something happy, surely:

*In a clear brook
With joyful haste
The whimsical trout
Shot past me like an arrow.*

I play the line of the song, I play the leaps and plunges of the right hand of the piano, I am the trout, the angler, the brook, the observer. I sing the words, bobbing my constricted chin. The Tononi does not object; it resounds. I play it in B, in A, in E flat. Schubert does not object.

* the type of violin, from the name of its maker

Text 3 — Essay

—by Ruth Wajnryb from *The Sydney Morning Herald*

Television brings us the news of the moment at the moment. Its hallmarks are immediacy, brevity and near verblessness. We want it now and fast, or not at all.

Constant stimulation and entertainment create the demand for constant stimulation and entertainment.

As a result, social commentator Hugh Mackay tells us, we're less skilled at communicating among ourselves, less capable of introspection and reflection, unused to down time. We're fixed on the compressed thought. Benchmarked by the sound bite.

What's developing is an intolerance for talk. Not all talk; a certain kind of talk - a sustained, exploratory, context-sensitive, inside-looking-out kind of talk.

It wasn't always like this. I can recall, at about age 15, asking my father to help me make sense of a line in a history textbook: "My neighbour is my enemy but my neighbour's neighbour is my friend."

The family was in the kitchen, just finishing an evening meal. Dad leapt up, energised by the challenge. He removed the dishes, wiped and dried the kitchen table, and then brought in a large historical atlas, opened at a map of Europe, circa 1871. Over the next hour, the late-19th century network of formal alliances and secret agreements fell out, as it were, on the shiny surface of the kitchen table. Europe was crisscrossed in a diplomatic tapestry of treaties, setting up the conditions for world war. And it all happened in my kitchen. I listened, spellbound.

There's no way, a generation later, I could repeat this scene. Even if I had the knowledge and the explanatory prowess, the question is unlikely to come forth. Too open-ended. Too prone to discursive drift.

So, not for us, the rambling thought or the digressive cul-de-sac, loosely connected by a flimsy segue. Life is short. There's no time to waste (sorry, spend) on idle chat or off-task moments. We're, all of us, time-poor. By the time we get around to having time to not worry about time, not much time is left.

There's a case, too, for the neat-and-brief. Arguably, the measure of a teacher, for example, is the good explanation. And the measure of this, at least in part, is conciseness, if only because its antithesis - long-windedness - is anathema.

In Paris a few years ago, I heard a memorable anecdote from the manager of an English-language school. I was there to talk about managing teachers. He reported that, for the first few years, he'd managed the school by the principles he'd learned on his MBA. But recruitment continued to challenge him and he made too many bad appointments. Eventually, he dispensed with what he'd learned formally, replacing it with intuition - and just one interview question. He asked interviewee teachers - mostly newly arrived Britons on working-holiday visas - how they got to the school that day.

The explanation, he claimed, turned out to be a reliable indicator of good teaching skills. He named the attributes he looked for: clarity, logical organisation, and - yes, you guessed it - brevity.

So, if you're keen, his school is three Metro stops past the Eiffel Tower, going north.

Text 4 — Poem

The Sleepout

- by Les Murray

Childhood sleeps in a verandah room
in an iron bed close to the wall
where the winter over the railing
swelled the blind on its timber boom

and splinters picked lint off warm linen
and the stars were out over the hill;
then one wall of the room was forest
and all things in there were to come.

Breathings climbed up on the verandah
when dark cattle rubbed at the corner
and sometimes dim towering rain stood
for forest, and the dry cave hunched woollen.

Inside the forest was lamplit
along tracks to a starry creek bed
and beyond lay the never-fenced country,
its full billabongs all surrounded

by animals and birds, in loud crustings,
and sometimes kept leaping up amongst them.
And out there, to kindle whenever
dark found it, hung the daylight moon.

Section II

The prescribed texts for Section II are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Anthony Doerr, *All the Light We Cannot See*
 - Amanda Lohrey, *Vertigo*
 - George Orwell, *Nineteen Eighty-Four*
 - Favel Parrett, *Past the Shallows*

- **Poetry**
 - Rosemary Dobson, *Rosemary Dobson Collected*
The prescribed poems are:
 - * *Young Girl at a Window*
 - * *Over the Hill*
 - * *Summer's End*
 - * *The Conversation*
 - * *Cock Crow*
 - * *Amy Caroline*
 - * *Canberra Morning*
 - Kenneth Slessor, *Selected Poems*
The prescribed poems are:
 - * *Wild Grapes*
 - * *Gulliver*
 - * *Out of Time*
 - * *Vesper-Song of the Reverend Samuel Marsden*
 - * *William Street*
 - * *Beach Burial*

- **Drama**
 - Jane Harrison, *Rainbow's End*, from Vivienne Cleven et al., *Contemporary Indigenous Plays*
 - Arthur Miller, *The Crucible*

- **Shakespearean Drama**
 - William Shakespeare, *The Merchant of Venice*

Section II prescribed texts continue on page 8

Section II prescribed texts (continued)

• **Nonfiction**

– Tim Winton, *The Boy Behind the Curtain*

* *Havoc: A Life in Accidents*

* *Betsy*

* *Twice on Sundays*

* *The Wait and the Flow*

* *In the Shadow of the Hospital*

* *The Demon Shark*

* *Barefoot in the Temple of Art*

– Malala Yousafzai and Christina Lamb, *I am Malala*

• **Film**

– Stephen Daldry, *Billy Elliot*

• **Media**

– Ivan O’Mahoney

* *Go Back to Where You Came From*

– Series 1: Episodes 1, 2 and 3

and

* *The Response*

– Lucy Walker, *Waste Land*

End of Stimulus Booklet

2019

Higher School Certificate
Trial Examination

English Advanced

Paper 1 — Texts and Human Experiences

**General
Instructions**

- Reading time – 10 minutes
- Working time – 1 hour and 30 minutes
- Write using black pen
- A Stimulus Booklet is provided with this paper
- Write your student and/or name at the top of every page

**Total marks:
40**

Section I – 20 marks (pages 2 – 5)

- Attempt Questions 1 – 4
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section II – 20 marks (pages 6 – 7)

- Attempt Question 5
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

This paper MUST NOT be removed from the examination room

STUDENT NUMBER/NAME:

Section I

20 marks

Attempt Questions 1 – 4

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
- analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts

Examine **Texts 1, 2, 3, 4** on **pages 2 to 6** in the Stimulus Booklet carefully and then answer the questions below.

Marks

Question 1

Use **Text 1 – Memoir** to answer this question.

How does **Text 1** explore the impact of significant moments in human experience?

4

[illegible]

STUDENT NUMBER/NAME:

Question 2

Use **Text 2 – Fiction** extract from *An Equal Music* to answer this question.

Evaluate the writer's effectiveness in **Text 2** in creating a character for whom the experience of music is essential.

7

[illegible]

STUDENT NUMBER/NAME:

Question 4

Use **Text 4 – Poem: *The Sleepout*** to answer this question.

Explain how **Text 4** evokes the experience of childhood in the country.

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Section II

20 marks

Attempt Question 5

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on a separate page or writing booklet, if provided.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
 - analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts
 - organise, develop and express ideas using language appropriate to audience, purpose and context
-

Question 5 (20 marks)

Answer **ONE** of the following questions.

The prescribed texts are listed in the Stimulus Booklet on pages 7 and 8.

(a) Prose Fiction

Writers help us to understand our world through their representation of how individuals react to human experiences.

Assess this statement by detailed reference to **ONE** prose fiction text from the prescribed list.

OR

(b) Poetry

A persona or speaker is often used effectively by poets to explore significant human experiences.

Assess this statement by detailed reference to **TWO** of the prescribed poems written by Rosemary Dobson or **TWO** of the prescribed poems written by Kenneth Slessor.

OR

(c) Drama

The representation of conflict as a human experience is a powerful technique used by playwrights to engage their audience.

Assess this statement by close reference to **ONE** play from the prescribed list.

Question 5 continues on page 7

Question 5 continued

(d) Shakespearean Drama

In *The Merchant of Venice*, Shakespeare engages the audience through his representation of conflict between individuals and between collective human experiences.

Assess this statement, with close reference to the play as a whole.

OR

(e) Nonfiction

Composers of nonfiction texts deal with human experiences that reveal values about which they feel strongly.

Assess this statement with close reference to *I am Malala*, OR a selection of Tim Winton's nonfiction pieces prescribed for study.

OR

(f) Film

In a film, visual techniques can be more powerful than what is said in conveying human experiences.

Assess this statement, by referring closely to the film you have studied from the prescribed list.

OR

(g) Media

Media composers use their texts to convey strongly held views about human experiences in society.

Assess this statement by referring closely to at least ONE of the media texts you have studied from the prescribed list.

End of paper